Junhao Zhang

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign **Expected Graduation: May 2029**
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics & Computer Science Cumulative GPA: 3.99/4.00
Bachelor of Arts in Spanish

SKILLS

Technical Skills: C/C++, Rust, TypeScript, React, Node.js, Java, Python, Git, LaTeX
Languages: English (Native), Chinese (Native), Spanish (Advanced Conversational Proficiency)

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

CS 225 (Data Structures in C++), **STATS 400** (Stats & Probability), **CS 128H** (Intro to Rust), **CS 357** (Numerical Methods)
Math 314 (Introduction to Higher Mathematics), **Math 257** (Linear Algebra with Computational Applications)

EMPLOYMENT AND RESEARCH

Cloudflare | Software Engineer Intern | Austin, TX **May 2026 – Aug 2026**
• Built and shipped an internal debugging tool for the WARP VPN client in React and Rust/WASM
• Refactored a prototype into production-quality code, adding agentic RAG-based lookup for preexisting issue resolutions
• Partnered with a PM on a spec grounded in existing workflows and iterated on feedback to consolidate fragmented tooling

CS128H | Course Assistant | Urbana, IL **January 2026 – Present**
• Host weekly office hours and provide one-on-one tutoring to clarify course concepts
• Design lecture presentations, and homework assignments for 60+ students in an introductory Rust course
• Collaborate with instructors to refine course content and improve learning outcomes

Punyasena Paleoecology Lab, SIB | Student Researcher | Urbana, IL **January 2026 – Present**
• Develop two-stage SAM2 (Segment Anything Model)-based pipeline to automatically segment pollen grains
• Design heuristic-driven prompting strategies resulting in accurate segmentation of all test data (30 samples)
• Present results in research poster at the Undergraduate Research Symposium with 750+ participants

PROJECTS

RusTX | github.com/cursorweb/raytracing-in-rust | Urbana, IL **November 2025 – December 2025**
• Led a team of 3 to design and implement a ray tracer in Rust as a CS128 Honors final project
• Applied Rust's concurrency features to create a multi-threaded renderer reducing render time from 10 minutes to 2 minutes

Europa Lang | github.com/cursorweb/europa-lang | Rochester, MN **September 2021 - Present**
• Implemented a dynamic programming language in Rust with a recursive descent parser
• Led a community of 4 maintainers, overseeing code reviews and feature proposals

CrabPen | github.com/CursorwebGames/2DThreePen | Rochester, MN **May 2026 - Present**
• Build Rust/WASM puzzle generator using Dancing Links to create unique-solution Queens puzzles in-browser
• Used benchmarks to apply targeted optimizations, cutting generation time for 14x14 boards from 13.2s to 200ms

ACTIVITIES

University of Illinois Symphony Orchestra | Violinist | Urbana, IL **August 2025 – Present**
• Perform in an Orchestra of music performance majors as well as highly talented non-majors
• Hold concerts 3 times per semester, with a variety of repertoire including works by Brahms, Shostakovich, Mahler, and Beethoven

Volunteer Income Tax Assistant (VITA) | Volunteer | Urbana, IL **January 2026 – Present**
• Contribute to the completion of 300+ tax returns in the community by helping verify eligibility for VITA services
• Provide Spanish-English translation, supporting community members via phone

HONORS AND AWARDS

Dean's List **2025, 2026**

Minnesota Bilingual Seal (Spanish and Chinese) - Platinum Level **2024, 2025**
• Demonstrate ACFTL advanced low proficiency in Speaking, Writing, Reading, and Listening in Chinese and Spanish